CHAPTER 6

Object Fundamentals

Objects have been a feature of PHP since version 3, and a great deal of PHP's built-in functionality is provided by objects (even if at glance, it doesn't seem that way; for example, anonymous functions are implemented internally as `Closure` objects). In addition to core PHP, most of the popular frameworks and libraries are implemented in the OOP style. We've already had some exposure to objects in previous chapters, and now is a good point to get the fundamentals down.

This chapter will focus on the object-oriented programming (OOP) features that PHP offers and how to use them. There might well be some features that don't make much sense or seem pointless at first: don't worry. The purpose of this chapter is simply to demonstrate what PHP has in its object toolbox. Why certain OOP features exist, and the best ways to use them, will be covered in Chapter 10, "Programming with Objects," later. For now, we will focus on the *what* and leave the *why* for later.

Here's what we will be covering in this chapter:

- Object instantiation
- Accessing static and non-static members
- Object context vs. class context
- Classes, anonymous classes, and their members
- Inheritance, abstract classes, and final classes
- Overloading and late static binding
- Interfaces
- Traits
- Enums

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